

more. As an added benefit, some places also get an IPTV connection along with their Google Fiber connection, which come with a 2 TB Digital Video Recorder that's capable of recording upto 8 simultaneous TV shows at a stretch. The top two paid tiers of Google Fiber connections also come with a terabyte of free Google Drive space. Google Fiber currently offers 3 paid plans – the basic internet package with 100 mbps of speed (both upload and download) for 50 dollars a month, the gigabit internet package at 70 dollars a month and the gigabit internet package with the IPTV connection at 160 dollars a month. Google Fiber's basic plan is free for certain public and affordable housing communities.

While it is amazing that Google is doing such a great thing to bring quality, fast broadband to the masses, we are not sure if their expectations are being met. Google has stated several times that it hopes that fast internet would spur innovations and discoveries from people who were gated otherwise by painfully slow connections, but the jury is still out if it has had any impact. Perhaps we'll never know because Google Fiber is a relatively small spike in America's network infrastructure. The seven chosen cities with their population, even if in the millions, is still too small a sample size and with Google Fiber having such a slow rate of growth, it might be many many years before we get any actual results. Not that we can fault Google of course – a city needs to have a dark fibre network already in place among other necessities for Google to even think about moving there. They don't turn huge profits with Fiber and throwing in extra installation costs would perhaps be the straw that breaks the camel's back. We'll just have to hope that the rate of expansion grows as long term users in the cities with access already start generating profits for Google and perhaps we can even dream that it'll expand out of the US to grace us worldwide. Until then, we'll just have to stare in envy.

Project Fi

Google's approach to connectivity is two-pronged – while Google Fiber tackles broadband at homes, Project Fi targets your smartphone. Or specifically, your smartphone's cellular connection. Project Fi is Google's own mobile carrier which promises great connections and mobile data at reasonable price points while also being customer centric and support friendly. Project Fi is a mobile virtual network operator, meaning that it actually doesn't own a stake in any of the wireless bands. Instead, it controls a part of the bands from several companies like Sprint, T-Mobile, U.S. Cellular, and